DunesForge - notes for beta testers

Version 0.85 beta. Thank you for testing DunesForge. Most things work, some will not, and your reports decide what is fixed before version 1.0.

Installing and updating

1. **Edit > Preferences > Get Extensions**, the small arrow in the top-right corner, **Install from Disk**. Pick the DunesForge ZIP. Do not unpack it.
2. **Restart Blender.** This is also needed after every update.
3. Press **N** in the 3D Viewport and open the **DunesForge** tab. The version is shown in the panel, for example **DunesForge build 0.85.1 beta**. If the panel says **RESTART BLENDER**, the old version is still running.

Step by step: Getting Started.

What to try

- Open two or three demo scenes and press **Play**.
- Make a dune field on your own terrain.
- With an NVIDIA card: click **Install CuPy GPU Backend** (it downloads about 1 to 2 GB), restart Blender and check that the panel says **Running on GPU**.
- Water, snow, painting, rendering: whatever you would use in a real project.
- Tell us also when something was confusing or did not do what you expected. That is a bug too.

Shallow water is a preview

Shallow water -- the flowing-water simulation and the demos marked **(Experimental)** -- is a preview. It needs deeper integration with the rest of the simulator and will probably not be part of the first release (1.0); it is planned for a version after it. The simple water level, rain and moisture are not affected. Try it and tell us what you think, but expect it to change.

Known limitations of this beta

- Tested on Windows with Blender 4.4 to 5.3. Blender 4.2 and 4.3, Linux and macOS have not been tested yet, so reports from them are especially welcome.
- GPU acceleration needs an NVIDIA card. AMD, Intel and Mac computers run on the CPU, which is slower.
- Flowing water is part of the running simulation and is not saved in the .blend file. Build a water demo again after opening the file.
- Some demos take a few minutes to build.
- Add-ons that bring their own CUDA libraries, for example BlendLuxCore, can stop the GPU backend from working. See Troubleshooting.

Reporting a problem

1. Click **Report a Bug** at the top of the DunesForge panel. It opens the bug form on GitHub. You can also write to **forgeplugins@gmail.com**.
2. **Attach the log file.** Click **Open Log Folder** in the main panel and attach **tydunes.log**.
3. Give the version from the panel, your Blender version and your graphics card.
4. Describe what you did, what you expected and what happened. A screenshot or a small .blend file that shows the problem helps a lot.

What the log contains

The DunesForge and Blender versions, the graphics card, the DunesForge buttons you pressed, the settings you changed before pressing them, error messages and the name of each .blend file you opened. It does not contain your scenes or any other files. Error messages can include folder paths, which may show your Windows user name. You can open tydunes.log in any text editor and read it before sending.